Name:
ID:

AOU
الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University

Arab Open University
FACULTY OF LANGUAGE STUDIES
TR103
Contrastive Analysis

Main - All Branches
Midterm

2025-2026 /Spring
Date: 15 April 2026
5:00 – 6:30

Number of Exam Pages: (including this cover sheet)	**8**	**Time Allowed:**	**1.5 hours**

INSTRUCTIONS:

1. Read **ALL** questions carefully and answer them in the space provided in this booklet.
2. Write your answers in **blue or black ink**. Answers in pencil will not be marked.
3. Edit and proofread your language carefully; linguistic accuracy and appropriate register part of the assessment.
4. No dictionaries, electronic devices, or reference materials are allowed.
5. Do not remove the staple or detach any pages from this exam booklet.

Grades:

Question Number	Minutes	Mark allocated (per question)	Earned Mark	Marker's I Signature
Question 1	15	5		
Question 2	25	5		
Question 3	20	10		
Question 4	30	10		
Total in Figures		30		
Total in Letters		Thirty Marks		

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Question 1: Short Notes (5 marks: 15 minutes)

In 60-80 words, explain the key differences between selectional restrictions and collocational restrictions. Your answer must include one specific example for each and their relevance to translation.

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Question 2: Translation of Idioms (5 marks: 25 minutes)

Read the excerpts below and their translation and answer the questions which follow.

ST	TT
لجأ المسؤول إلى ضرب الودع لتبرير قراره المثير للجدل، غير أن المحللين رأوا أنه كان يحاول التحايل على القانون بـإلقاء الحجر في المياه الراكدة.	The official resorted to hitting the shells to justify his controversial decision, but analysts believed he was trying to circumvent the law by throwing a stone in still water.

1. **Identify and name the translation error made in rendering ONE idiom ONLY from Arabic into English. (1.5 mark: 0.5 mark for correct identification of the idiom and 1 mark for naming the error)**

Idiom: _____

Error: _____

2. **Provide a correct, idiomatic English translation for the idiom. (1 mark)**

_____

_____

ST	TT
The Prime Minister accepted the painful political situation and decided to bite the bullet although this decision would open a can of worms for his government.	قرر رئيس الوزراء أن يقبل الوضع السياسي المؤلم ويعضّ الرصاصة رغم أنه يعلم أن قراره سيفتح علبة الديدان على حكومته.

1. **Identify and name the translation error made in rendering ONE idiom ONLY from Arabic into English. (1.5 mark: 0.5 mark for correct identification of the idiom and 1 mark for naming the error)**

Idiom: _____

Error: _____

2. **Provide a correct, idiomatic Arabic translation for the idiom. (1 mark)**

_____

_____

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Question 3: Achieving Equivalence on the Word Level (10 marks: 20 minutes)

Read the Arabic text below and answer the questions which follow.

مع قدوم رمضان هذا العام في فصل الشتاء، تختلف تجربة الصيام اليومية بشكل واضح مقارنة برمضان في الصيف، فساعات الصيام تكون أقصر، كما يتغير نشاط الجسم وأسلوب النوم ومستوى الطاقة والمزاج العام. فيؤثر الطقس البارد على طريقة تعامل الجسم مع الطعام والنوم والطاقة، مما يجعل فهم هذه التغيرات ضروريا للتعامل مع الشهر الفضيل بصورة صحية ومتوازنة، للحفاظ على النشاط والراحة طوال أيامه.

Source: https://www.ajnet.me/lifestyle/

1. Translate the whole text into English while adhering to the norms and conventions of English style. (5 marks)

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2. Identify the word-level equivalence problem encountered in translating "الصيام" into English, name the strategy you used to resolve it, and briefly justify your choice. (5 marks: 2 marks for the problem, 2 marks for the strategy, and 1 mark for the justification)

Problem: _____

Strategy: _____

Justification: _____

_____

Question 4: Critical Reflection (10 marks: 30 minutes)

Read the Arabic translation below for a news on the war in Iran and write a short critical reflection of 100-120 words drawing on your understanding of Baker's (2018) concept of grammatical equivalence. In your reflection, discuss the strategies and techniques the translator used to overcome non-equivalence on the grammatical level.

ST	TT
The Israeli military has said it carried out several wide-scale waves of strikes across Iran, as supporters of the Islamic Republic staged rallies to celebrate the appointment of a new supreme leader. Iranian state TV announced late on Sunday that Mojtaba Khamenei had been elected the new supreme leader by the Assembly of Experts, a body of 88 Shia clerics. In his first reaction to the decision, US President Donald Trump said he was "not happy". Meanwhile, Iran launched new barrages of missile and drones at Gulf Arab states hosting US military bases and Israel, where one person was killed on Monday. Source: https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/c3dzy4nede0o	أعلن الجيش الإسرائيلي أنه نفّذ عدة موجات واسعة من الضربات في أنحاء إيران، في حين نظّم أنصار الجمهورية الإسلامية مسيرات احتفالاً بتعيين مرشد أعلى جديد. وأعلن التلفزيون الإيراني الرسمي، في وقت متأخر من مساء الأحد، انتخاب مجتبى خامنئي مرشداً أعلى جديداً من قبل مجلس الخبراء، وهو هيئة تضم 88 رجل دين شيعي. وفي أول رد فعل له على القرار، قال الرئيس الأمريكي دونالد ترامب إنه "غير راضٍ." في غضون ذلك، شنّت إيران وابلاً جديداً من الصواريخ والطائرات المسيّرة على دول الخليج العربي التي تستضيف قواعد عسكرية أمريكية، وعلى إسرائيل، حيث قُتل شخص واحد يوم الاثنين.

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